



Training Manual

A practical guide for Magistrates and Clerks

VERSION 0.2.0 · EARLY ALPHA · AUGUST 2026

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SECTION 1

Welcome to Magistrate Wizard

How this manual works

Magistrate Wizard is a case-management and legal research workspace built for magistrates' courts. It brings together your **docket** (the matters you're hearing), a shared **case law and legislation library**, your own **judgments and bench notes**, and reusable **quick codes** for common orders — all in one place, on desktop, tablet, or phone.



This is an early alpha release

Screens and features shown in this manual may change as the system evolves. The workflow and vocabulary described here — the matter lifecycle, roles, and core screens — are stable; exact button placement may shift between releases.

This manual is split into two parts:

- 1 Part A — Magistrate Guide** covers everything a sitting magistrate needs: managing a docket, recording hearing progress, drafting judgments, and approving clerk access.
- 2 Part B — Clerk Guide** covers what a court clerk sees: requesting access to a court, and working the docket once approved.

Icons used throughout this manual match the icons you'll see in the app itself, so you can recognise a screen at a glance. See the **Icon Reference** appendix at the back for the full legend.



SECTION 2

Understanding Roles

Three roles, three different views of the same system

Role	Who	What they see
 Magistrate	A sitting magistrate	Full access to their assigned court(s): docket, case law, legislation, judgments, bench notes, quick codes, calendar, and clerk approvals.
 Clerk	Court administrative staff	Docket access only, and only for courts a magistrate has explicitly approved. No case law, legislation, judgments, or quick codes — a clerk's workspace is deliberately narrow.
 Administrator	System administrator	Manages court assignments and the shared legal library. Not covered in depth in this manual — see your system administrator.



Clerks start with almost nothing visible

This is by design, not a bug. A brand-new clerk account has no court access until a magistrate approves a request (Section 17). Until then, the dashboard simply shows a pending-approval message.



SECTION 3

Signing In

Every user, magistrate or clerk, starts here

Open the app in your browser (or the mobile app) and go to the sign-in screen. Enter the email address and password issued to you by your court administrator.

- 1 Enter your court email address.
- 2 Enter your password.
- 3 Select **Sign In**.
- 4 First time here? Select **Create one** to register — see below.



Registering a new account

New accounts default to the Magistrate role with no court assigned — an administrator must assign a court before the account is fully useful. Registering as a Clerk instead sends your court choice straight into the approval queue described in Section 17, so you don't need a separate step afterward.

PART A

Magistrate Guide

Everything a sitting magistrate needs day to day.

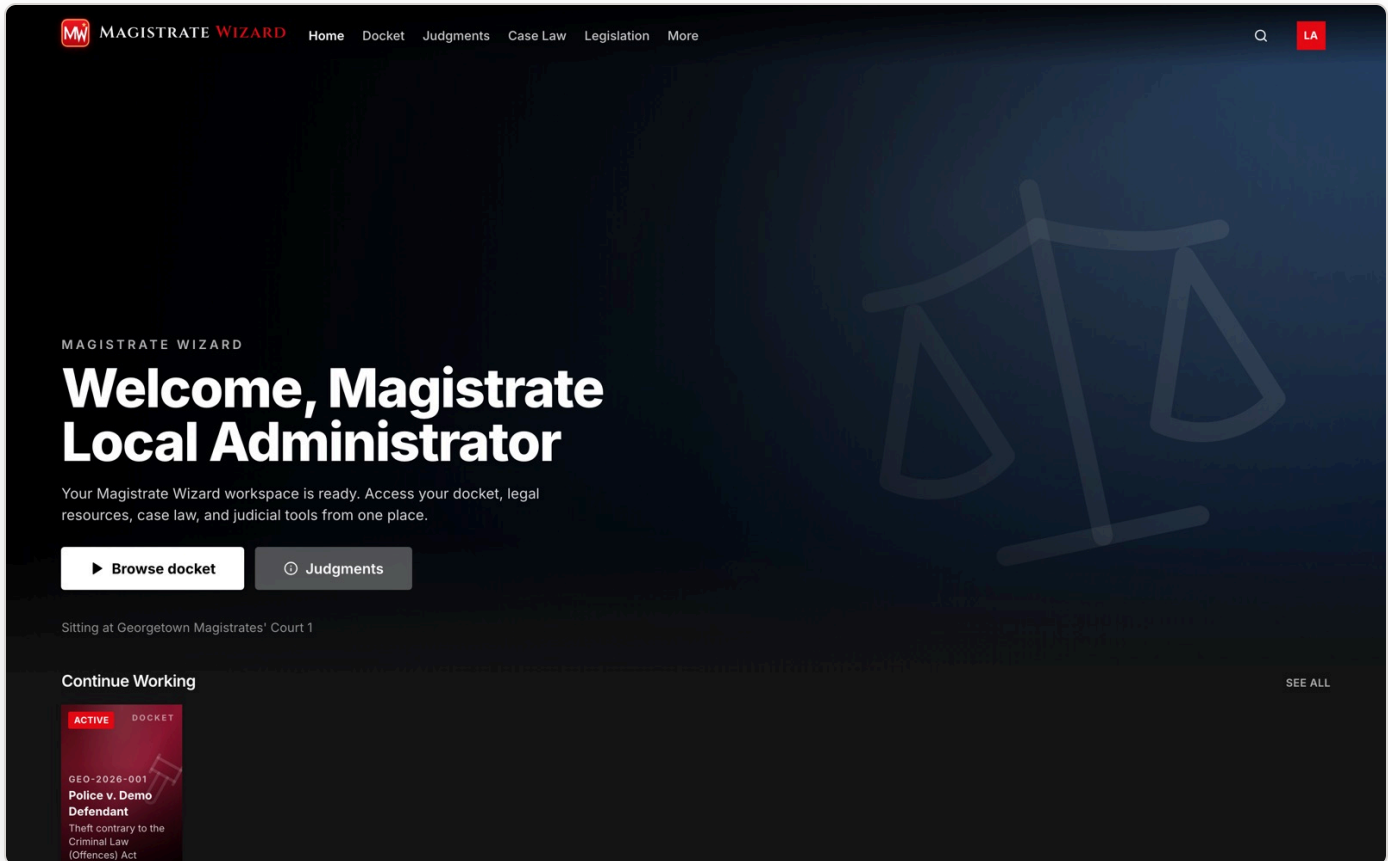


SECTION 4

Your Dashboard

The first thing you see after signing in

Your dashboard is a personalised summary of your active work: matters you're partway through, upcoming appearances, and drafts waiting to be finished.



The magistrate dashboard, with quick access to Docket and Judgments

- 1 **Continue Working** — matters you've recently touched, shown as cover cards.
- 2 **Upcoming Appearances** — what's on your list soon.
- 3 **Draft & Final Judgments** — writing in progress and completed work.
- 4 **Retained / Part-Heard Matters** — matters you've chosen to keep after your court assignment changed (see Section 6).
- 5 **Bench Notes & Quick Codes** — fast links back into your personal reference material.



No court assigned yet?

You'll see a banner explaining this. Judgments, Case Law, Quick Codes, and Bench Notes still work normally — only the Docket needs a court assignment from your administrator.



SECTION 5

The Docket — Your Caseload

Where matters live, from arraignment to appeal

The Docket screen, with the Docket Capacity calendar expanded above the matter list

The Docket is your working sheet. If you sit at more than one court, a court switcher appears at the top so you can move between them; your last choice is remembered on this device.

- 1 List / Tiles toggle** — List is the dense spreadsheet-style working view. Tiles shows cover-photo cards, better for browsing on a phone.
- 2 Docket Capacity** — a month calendar showing hearing load per day (see Section 8). Click any day to filter the list to that date; select **All Matters** to clear the filter.
- 3 Search** — by case number, title, or issue.
- 4 Filters** — narrow by stage or procedure status.
- 5 New matter** — opens the create-matter form (below). Disabled if you have no current court assignment.

Creating a new matter

- 1 Select New matter.**
- 2 Choose the Court** — the magisterial district fills in automatically.
- 3 Enter the Case number and Matter title.**

4 Optionally add the **Charge / issue** now, or leave it for later.



SECTION 6

Working a Docket Matter

Seven tabs, one record

A docket matter's Overview tab, showing the case-lifecycle strip and hearing progress panel

Opening a matter from the Docket takes you to its record, organised into tabs across the top:

Overview Status, the case-lifecycle strip (Section 7), charge/issue, orders & outcome, next date, custody status, and hearing-progress history.

Parties Accused, complainants, and other parties — name, role, type, attorney, and an optional photo (becomes the matter's cover image).

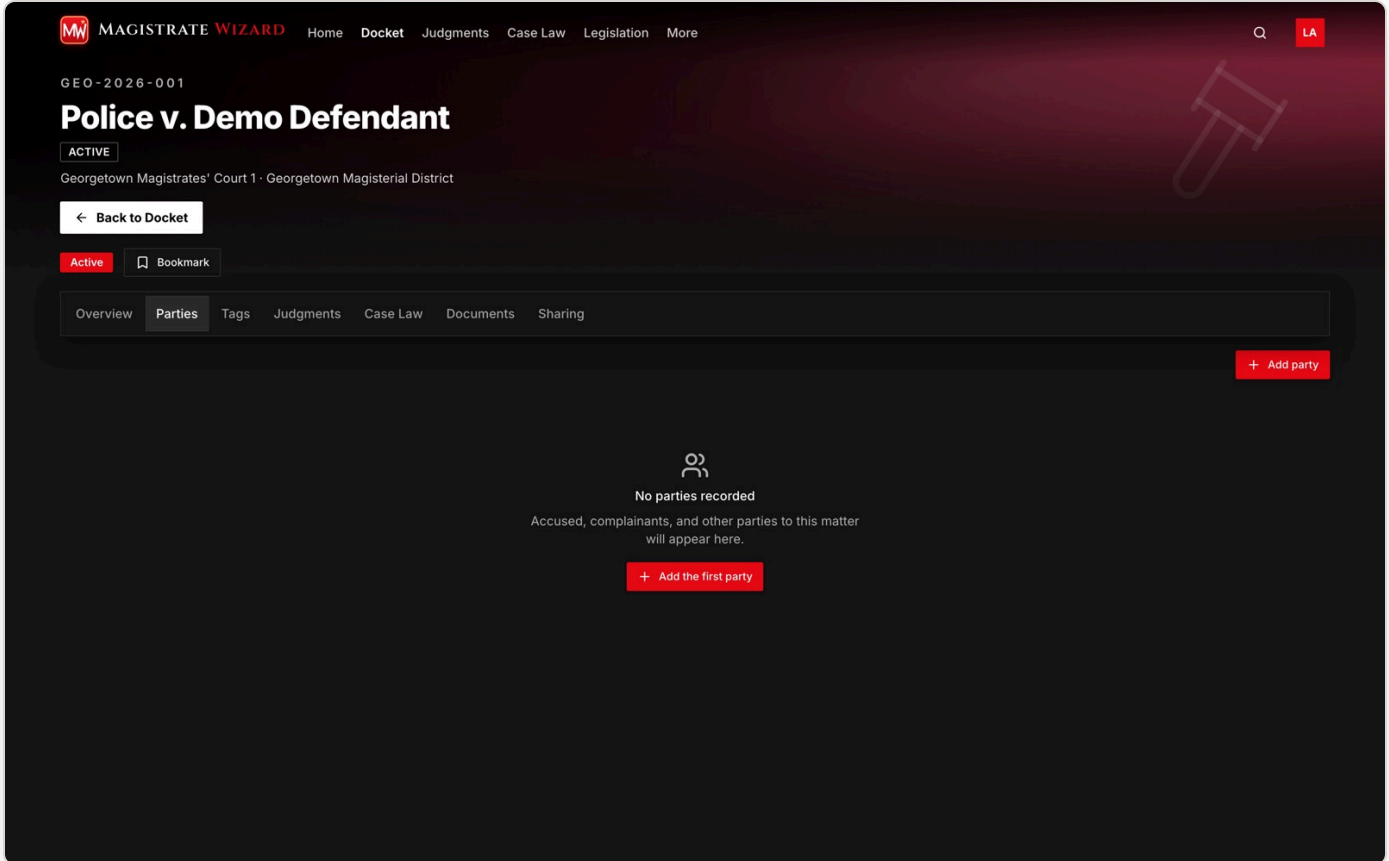
Tags Free-form labels for your own filtering and organisation.

Judgments Link one of your own judgment documents to this matter as reference material.

Case Law Link authorities from the Case Law Library (Section 9) directly to this matter.

Documents Upload and manage files attached to the matter.

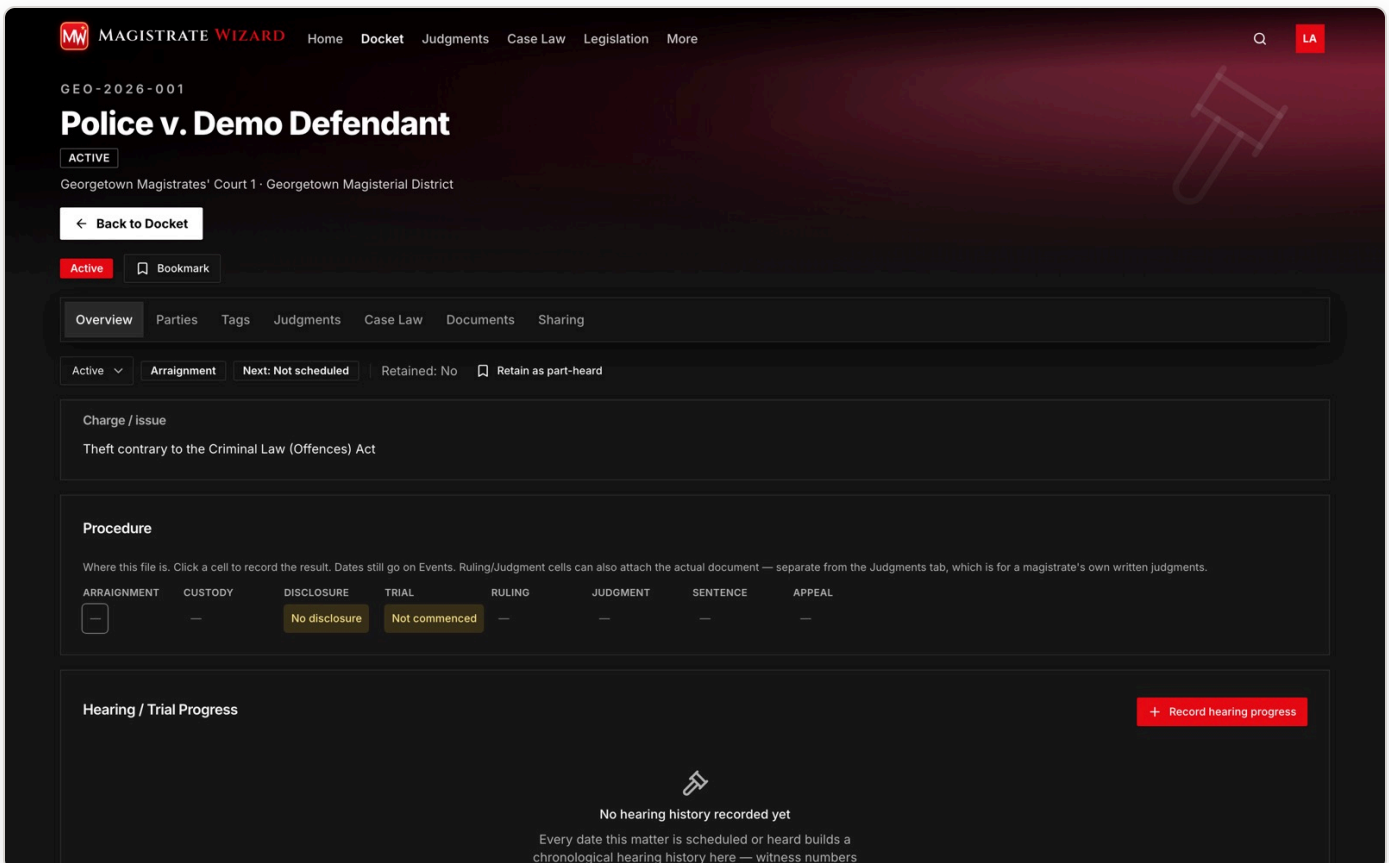
Sharing Grant another user access to this specific matter.



The Parties tab — accused, complainants, and other parties on record

Recording hearing progress

Every date a matter is scheduled or heard builds a chronological history. Select **Record hearing progress** on the Overview tab to log what happened, and use the **Events** view to schedule the next date, time, location, and any orders made.



Scheduling and reviewing events on a matter



Retain as part-heard

If your court assignment changes partway through a matter you've already heard, use Retain as part-heard to keep your own access to it. You can end that retention yourself once the matter concludes.

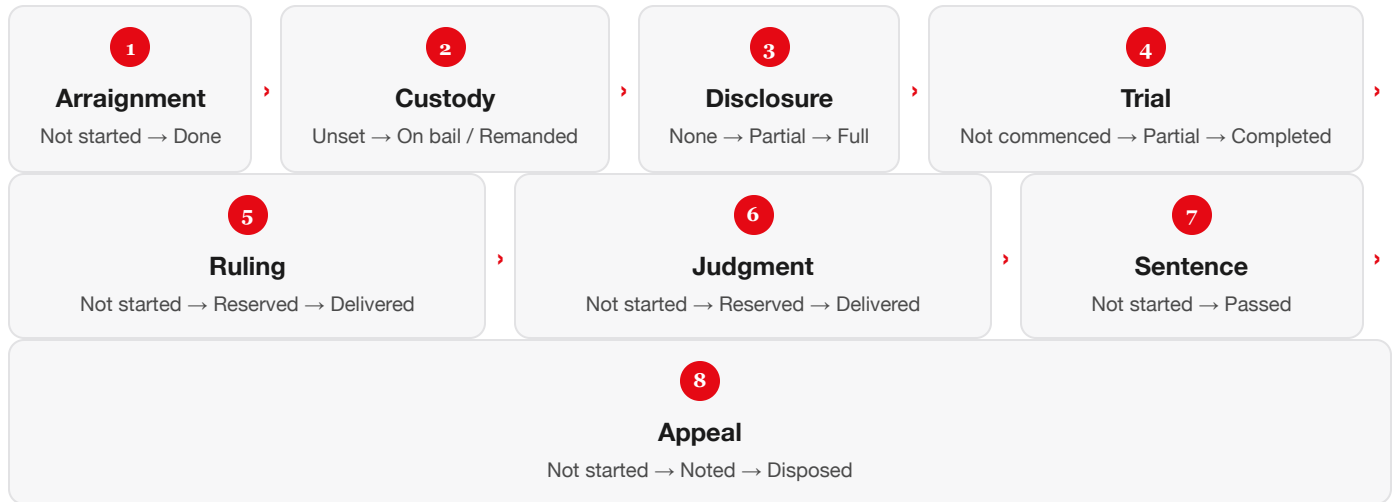


SECTION 7

The Case Lifecycle at a Glance

Eight independent stages, one strip

Every docket matter tracks eight stages side by side on its Overview tab. Each is set independently — a matter can be mid-trial while sentence is still “not started”, or disclosure can be partial while custody status is already resolved. Click any stage badge to update it.



These stages are a record, not a workflow gate

You can set any stage in any order — the strip reflects reality on the file, it doesn't enforce a sequence. This matters for matters that skip steps (a guilty plea skips Trial) or move non-linearly (a remand can happen at any point).



SECTION 8

Docket Capacity Planning

See overbooked days before you create them

The Docket Capacity strip is a month-view calendar that colour-codes each day by hearing load against a configurable limit, broken down by matter category (Trials, Maintenance, Liability, Protection Order / Family Violence, and more).

- 1 Click any day to filter the Docket list to just that date's matters.
- 2 Select **All Matters** to clear the date filter.
- 3 Use the settings dialog to adjust per-category limits for your court.
- 4 Select **Generate Daily Progress Report** from a filtered day to export a printable summary.



SECTION 9

Case Law Library

Shared institutional research, plus your own

The Case Law Library, filterable by Court, Jurisdiction, and Category

Canonical

The shared institutional library, curated and available to every magistrate. Filter by Court, Jurisdiction, or Category — the filter counts shrink live to only valid combinations.

My Research

Cases you've added yourself, private by default.

Discoverable

Other magistrates' research they've marked shareable.

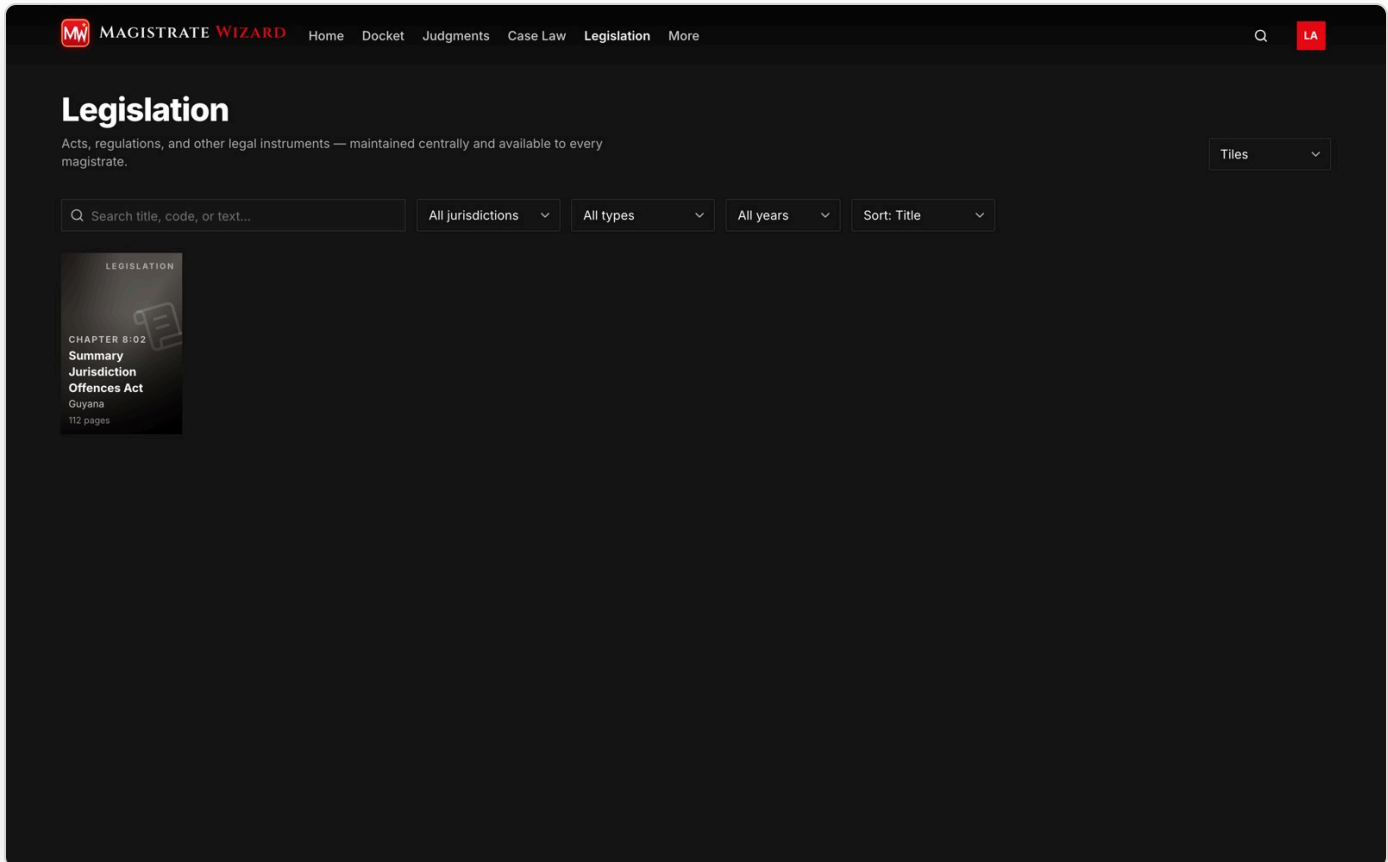
Open any case to search its full text, add it to **Bookmarks**, write personal **Annotations**, attach reference **Documents**, or **Link to a Docket Matter** — which also shows up from the matter's own Case Law tab (Section 6).



SECTION 10

Legislation Library

The statute book, section by section



Browsing the Legislation library

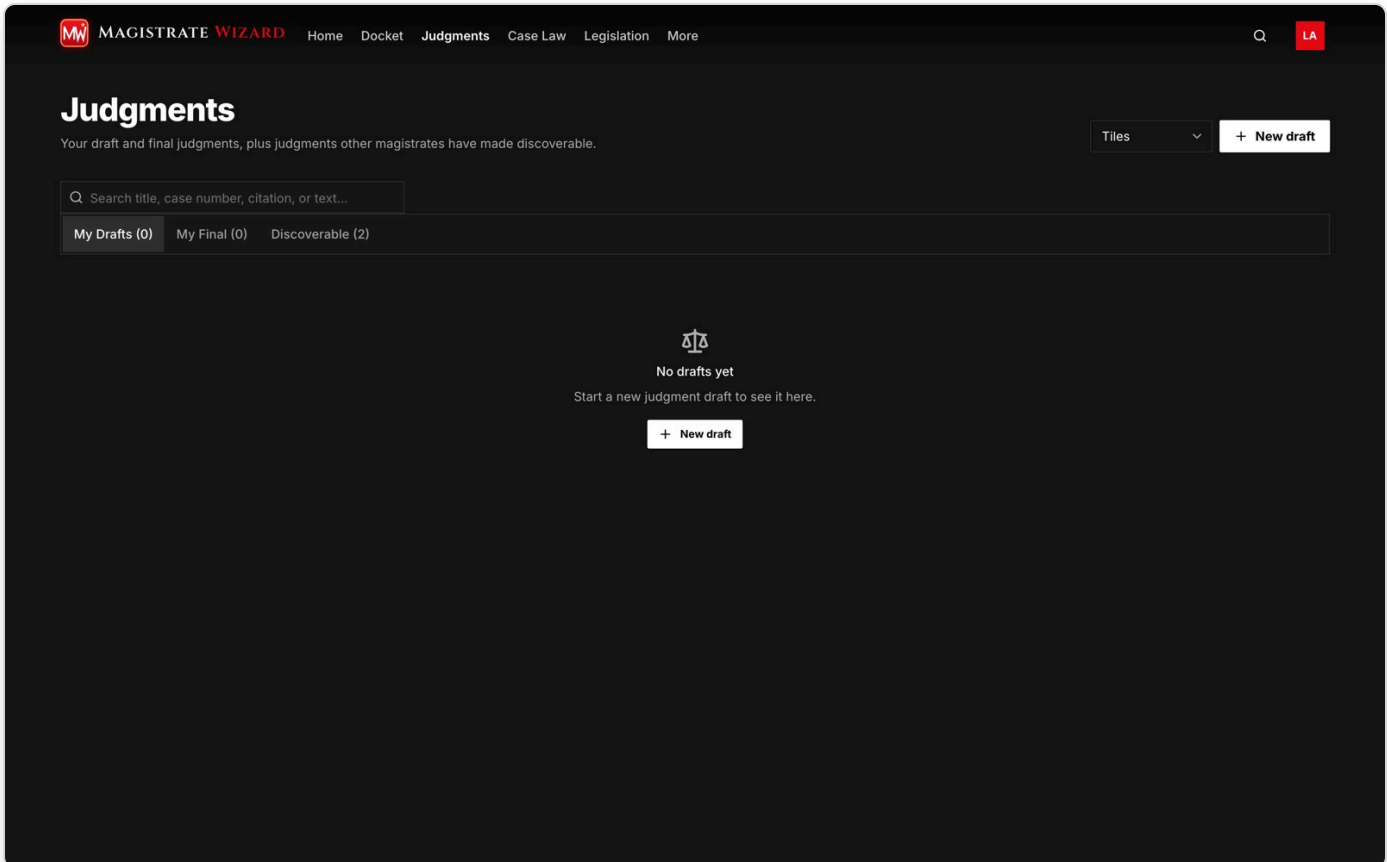
A centrally maintained library of statutes, browsable and filterable by jurisdiction, document type, and enactment year. Each statute breaks down into individual **provisions** (sections) that you can deep-link to, bookmark, or attach a bench note to directly — useful when you want a note tied to one specific section rather than the whole Act.



SECTION 11

Judgments

Your own written decisions, drafts through final



The Judgments list, with Draft, Final, and Discoverable tabs

Only one field is required to start a judgment — everything else can be filled in as you go:

- 1 Select **New Judgment**.
- 2 Enter a **Title** (required).
- 3 Optionally add Case number, Court name, Judgment date, and Citation now or later.
- 4 Write and save — it stays in **My Drafts** until you mark it final.

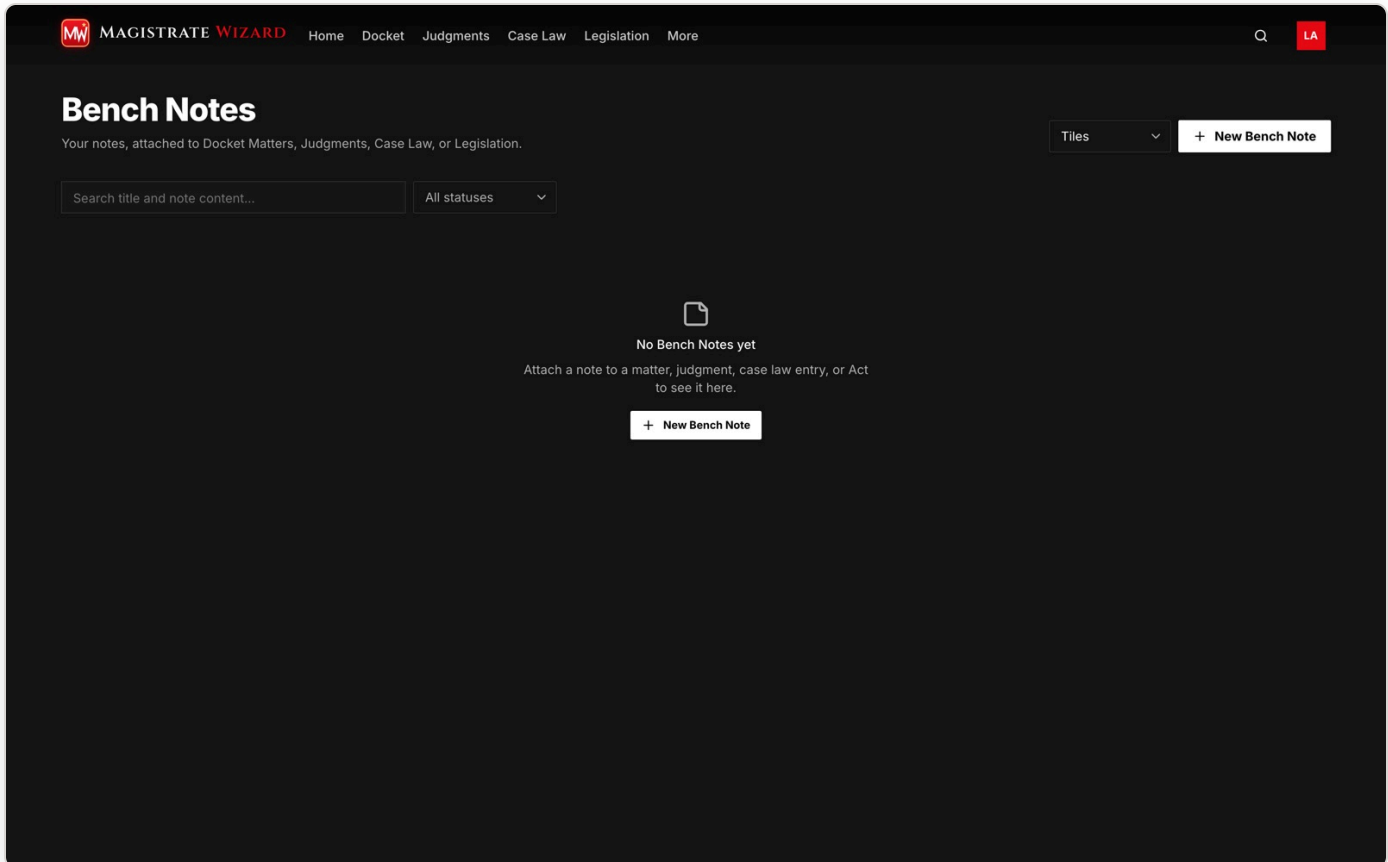
Search reaches across title, case number, citation, and body text. Once written, a judgment can be linked to its docket matter from either the Judgments tab on the matter, or from here.



SECTION 12

Bench Notes

Your personal notes, attached to anything



Bench Notes, filterable by status and by what they're attached to

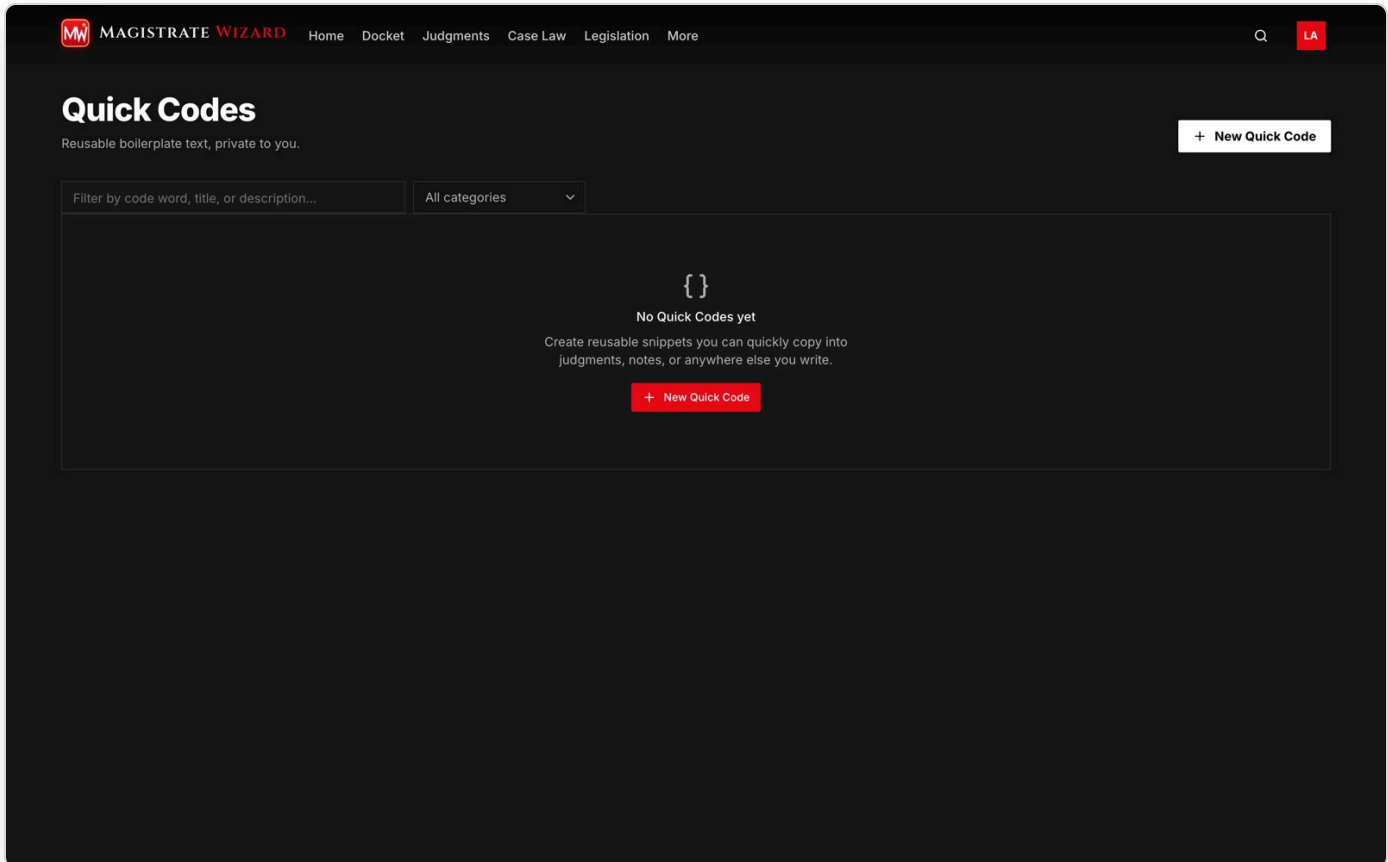
A bench note is a private note you can attach to a **Docket Matter**, a **Judgment**, a **Case Law** entry, or a specific **Legislation provision**. Search covers both the title and the full note content, and the list can be filtered by status or by which type of record a note is attached to.



SECTION 13

Quick Codes

Boilerplate text, one click away



Quick Codes, organised by category with a one-click Copy action

Quick codes are reusable boilerplate text, private to you — the standard wording for a common order, written once and reused every time you need it.

- 1 Give the code a memorable **code word** and, optionally, a title.
- 2 Write the **content** — the actual text you want to reuse.
- 3 File it under a **category**: Adjournments, Bail, Sentencing, Evidence, Procedural Orders, Warrants, Maintenance, Juvenile, or Administrative.
- 4 Use **Copy** from the list to grab the text whenever you need it.

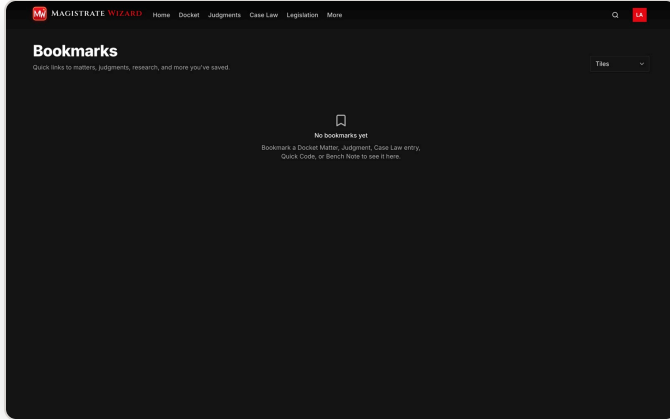
Quick codes can also be bookmarked and associated with case law, docket matters, or judgments for faster retrieval later.



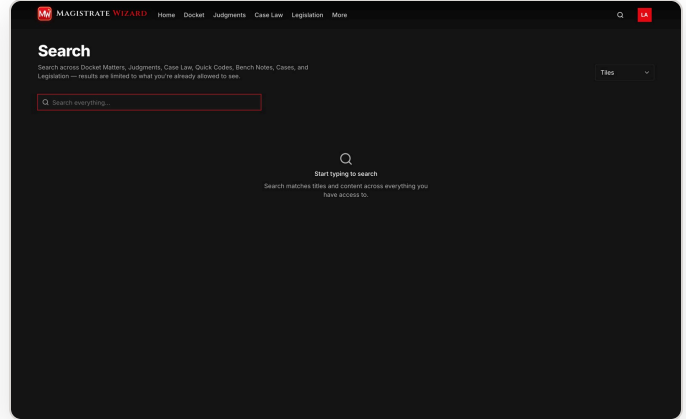
SECTION 14

Bookmarks & Search

Everything you've saved, everything you can find



Bookmarks — everything you've saved across the app



Global search across the workspace

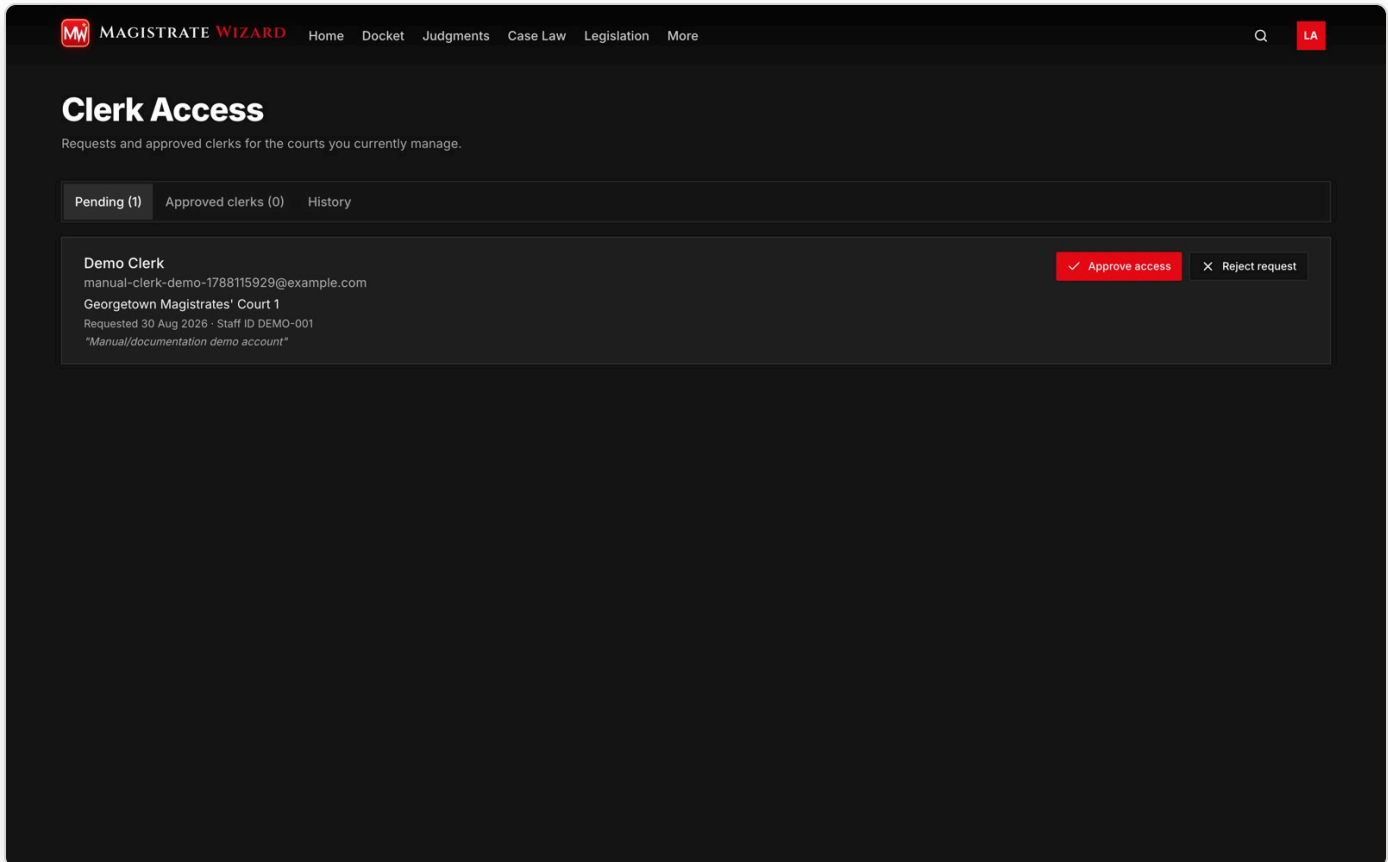
The bookmark icon appears throughout the app — on case law, legislation provisions, quick codes, and more — and everything you save collects in one place. Global **Search** reaches across the whole workspace at once, rather than one library at a time.



SECTION 15

Approving Clerk Access

You decide who can see your court's docket



Reviewing a pending clerk access request

When a clerk requests access to a court you manage, it lands here for your decision — three tabs keep the picture clear:

Pending

Requests awaiting your decision. Each shows the clerk's name, email, requested court, staff ID, and any note they included. **Approve** or **Reject** (with a reason) directly from here.

Approved clerks

Your current roster for this court — revoke access at any time.

History

A record of past decisions.



If a court has no magistrate assigned yet

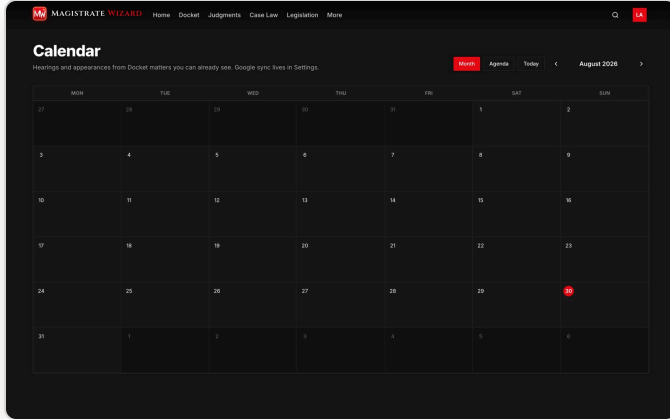
Requests for a court with zero authorized magistrates fall through to a system administrator, who can only point at the gap in the court roster — they cannot approve on your behalf. Getting your own court assignment sorted first keeps this from happening.



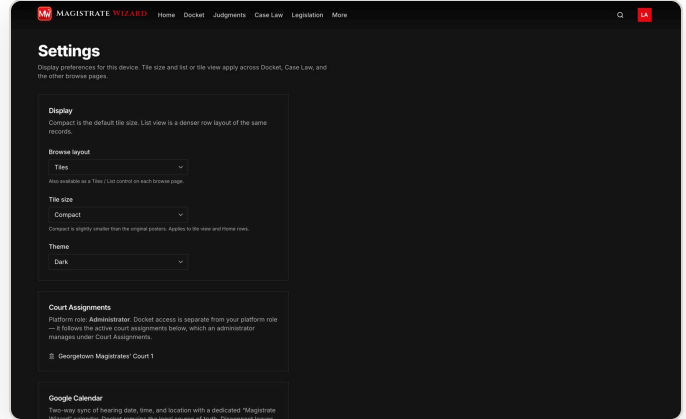
SECTION 16

Calendar & Settings

Your schedule, and how the app behaves for you



The Calendar view



Settings — display, court assignments, and account preferences

Settings covers your display preferences, a read-only view of the court assignments an administrator has given you, calendar-sync options, and general account information.

PART B

Clerk Guide

Requesting access, and working the docket once you have it.

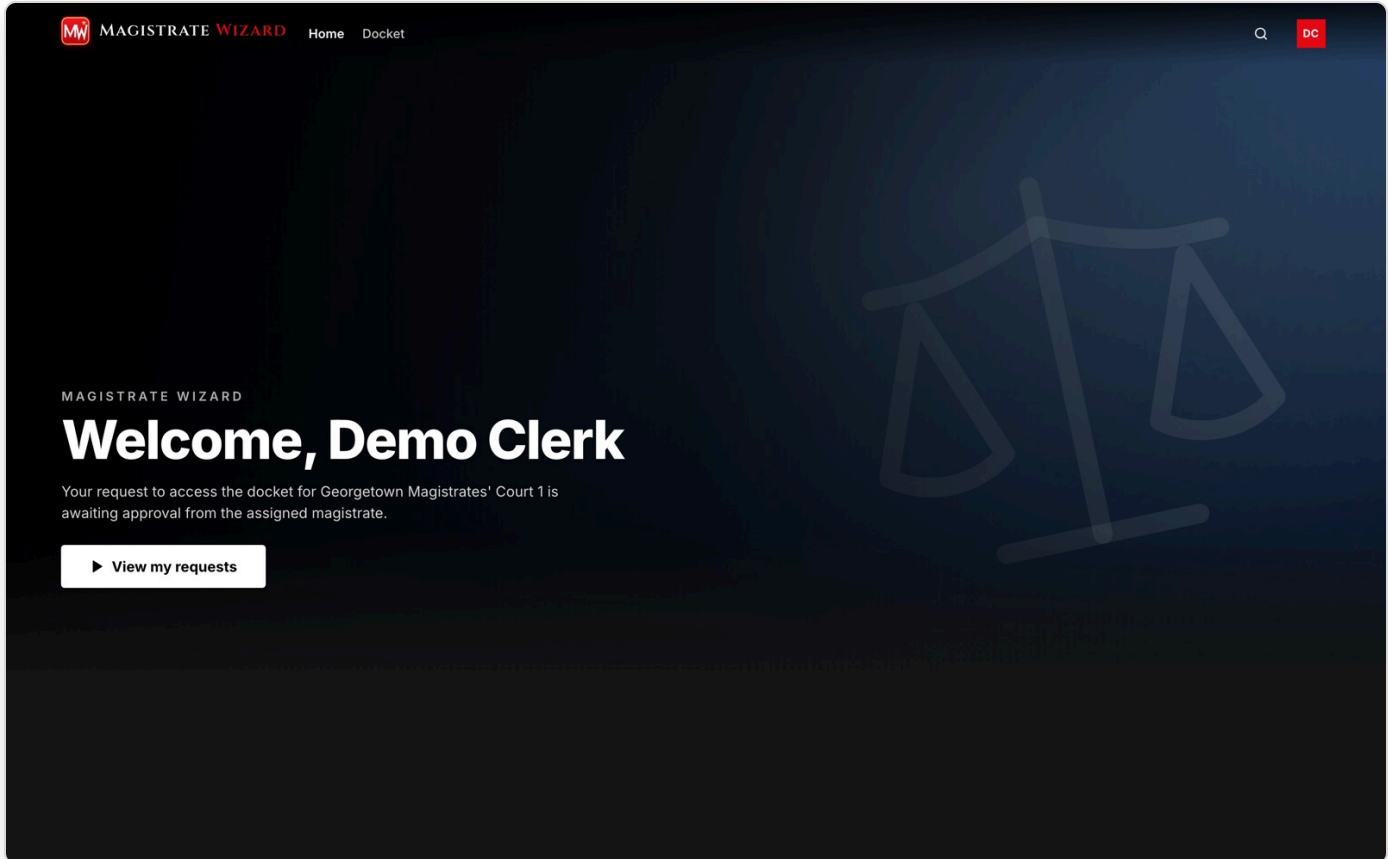


SECTION 17

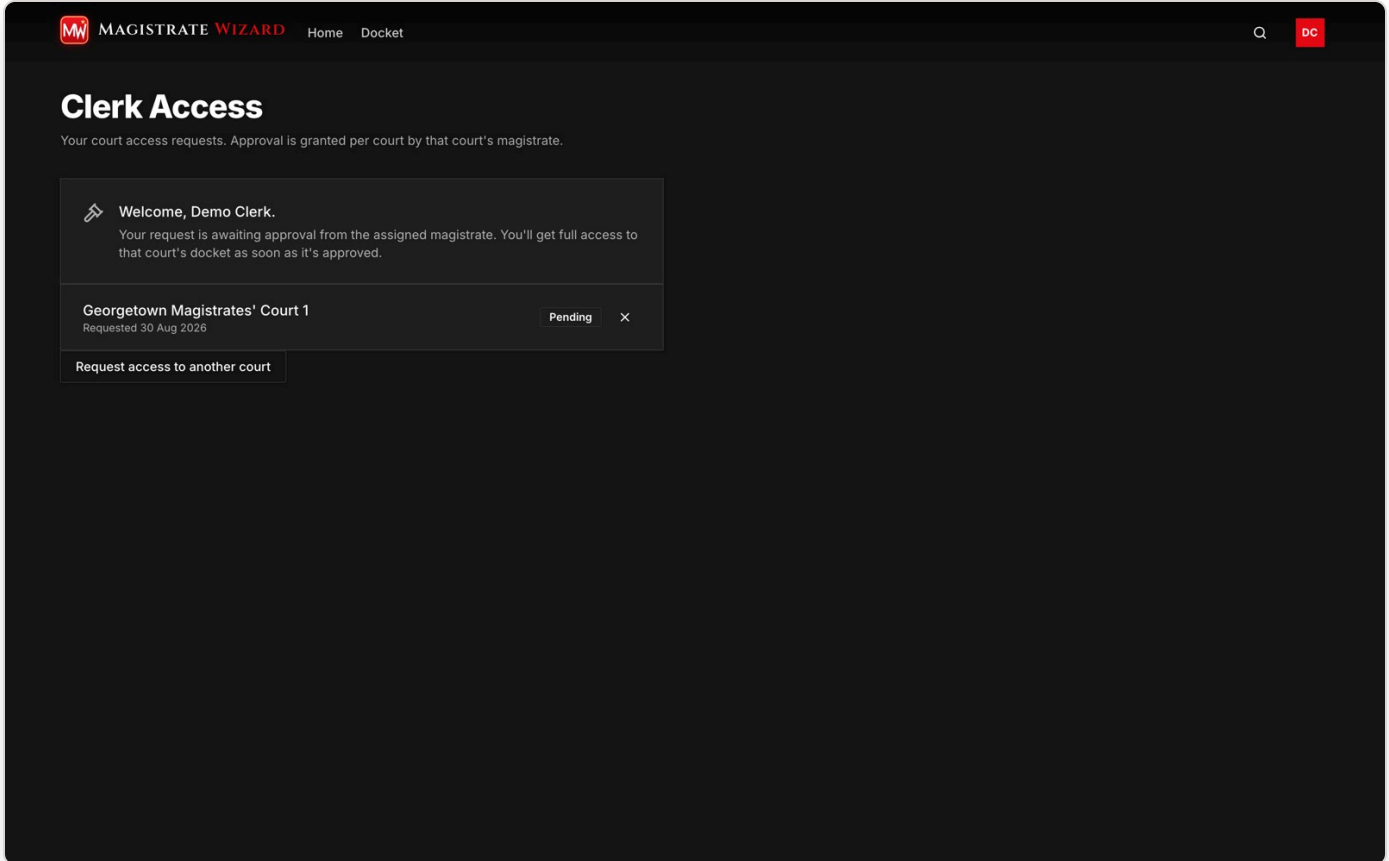
Requesting Court Access

One request per court, reviewed by a magistrate

Register or sign in, then go to **Clerk Access** to ask for a specific court. Until a magistrate at that court approves you, your dashboard stays intentionally quiet.



A clerk's dashboard while a request is still pending



The Clerk Access screen, showing a request awaiting review

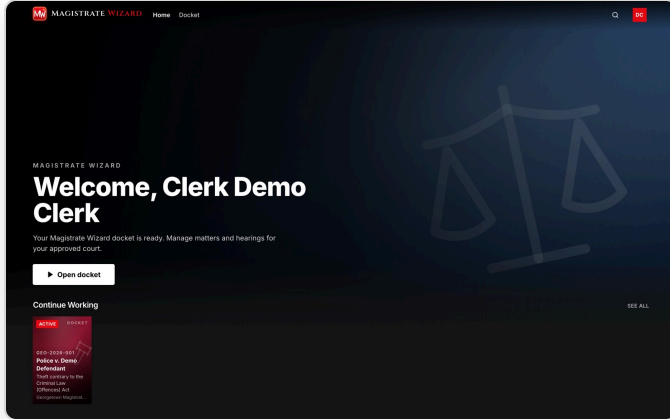
- 1 Go to **Clerk Access**.
- 2 Select **Request Access**, choose the district and court, and add your staff ID and an optional note.
- 3 Submit — the request goes straight to that court's magistrate(s) for review.
- 4 Track the true status of every request you've made — pending, approved, or rejected — right here. Cancel a pending request at any time, or request another court.



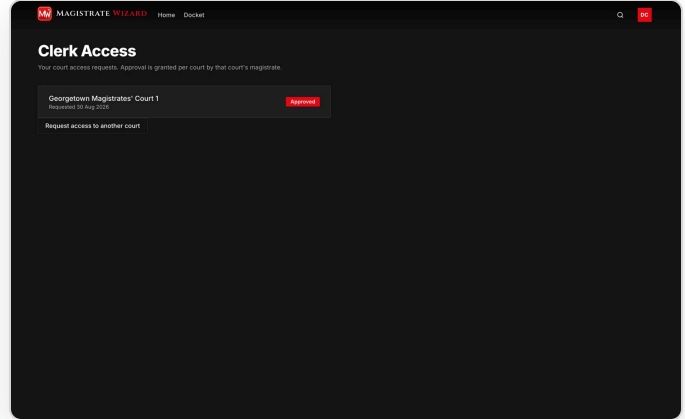
SECTION 18

Once You're Approved

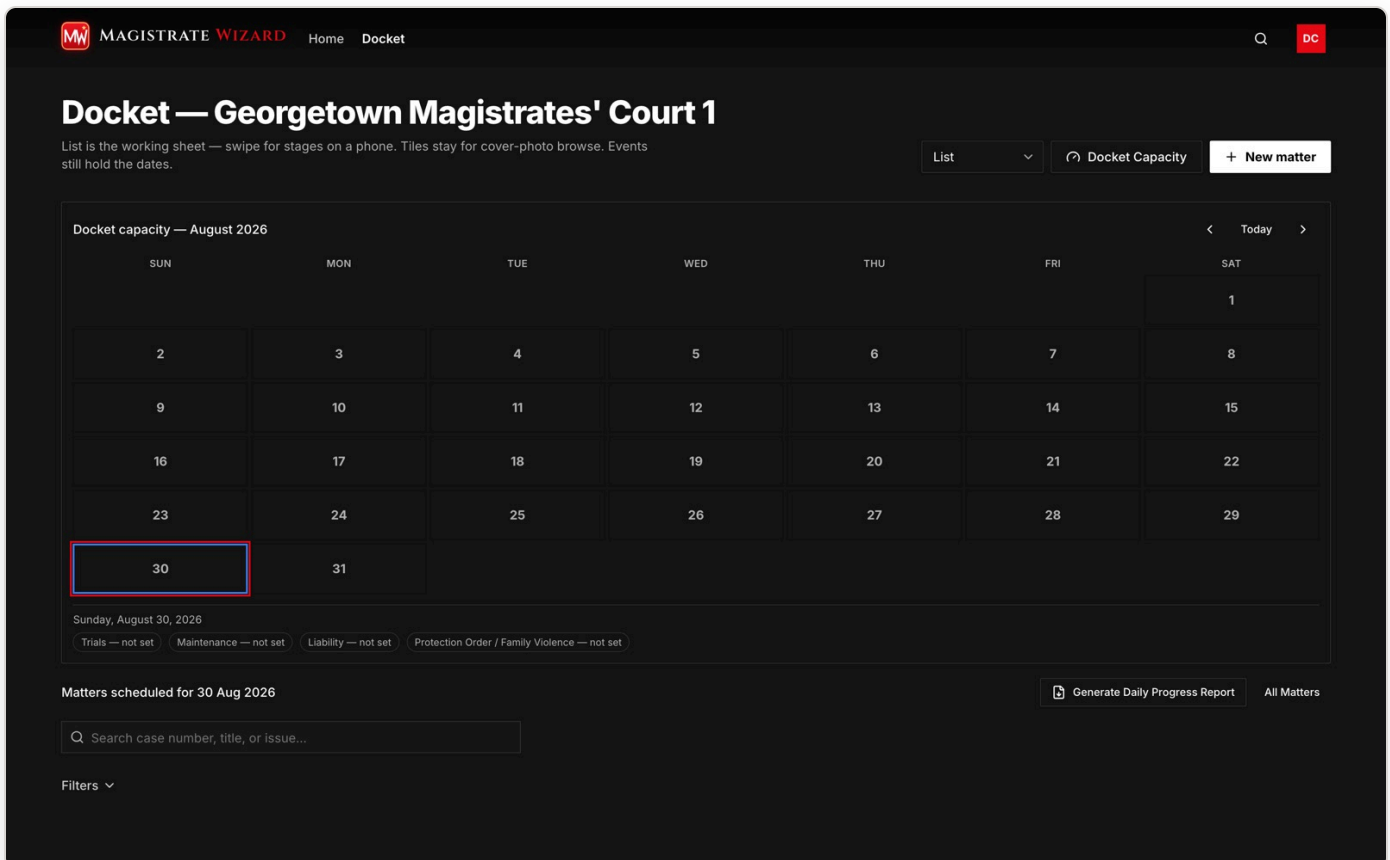
The docket opens up



The clerk dashboard once a court has approved access



Clerk Access showing an approved court



The Docket, now visible to an approved clerk

Your dashboard now shows **Continue Working** and **Upcoming Appearances** for that court, plus a straight **Open Docket** shortcut. The Docket itself works exactly as described in Section 5 — same list/tiles toggle, same capacity calendar, same search and filters.



SECTION 19

What a Clerk Can & Can't Do

A deliberately narrow workspace

Compare a clerk's navigation menu to a magistrate's: everything below the top two rows simply isn't there for a clerk account.

Area	Magistrate	Clerk
Dashboard	Full	Own summary
Docket (approved courts only)	Full	Full
Calendar	Yes	—
Case Law / Legislation Library	Yes	—
Judgments	Yes	—
Bench Notes / Quick Codes	Yes	—
Bookmarks / Global Search	Yes	—
Approve other clerks	Yes	—

This isn't a restriction to work around — it reflects the job. A clerk's role centres on docket administration for the courts they support, not legal research or judgment-writing.



SECTION A

Appendix — Icon Reference

Every icon used in this manual, and what it means in the app



Dashboard / Home



Docket / Matter



Calendar



Case Law



Legislation



Judgments



Bench Notes



Quick Codes



Bookmarks



Search



Clerk Access



Settings



Clerk role



Approved



Case lifecycle



Important note



SECTION B

Appendix — Getting Help

Who to contact when something doesn't match this manual



This is an early alpha release

Features, screens, and even some navigation labels are still being refined. If something in the live app doesn't match this manual, trust the app and flag the difference to your system administrator so this manual can be corrected.

Account or password issues

Contact your court administrator.

Court access requests

Contact the magistrate(s) assigned to the court in question (Section 15 / 17).

Something looks wrong or broken

Note the screen, what you expected, and what happened, then report it to your administrator.